Move-Out Deposit Checklist

For renters in England. Clean to the standard on your check-in inventory – not better – put back what you changed, and keep dated evidence of everything.

About four weeks before

- [ ] Find your check-in inventory and move-in photos – that's the standard you'll be measured against.
- [ ] Check your deposit is protected (Deposit Protection Service, mydeposits or Tenancy Deposit Scheme).
- [ ] List anything you changed or added: hooks, shelves, paint, light shades, furniture moved.
- [ ] Ask your landlord in writing what they want done about any changes you made with permission.
- [ ] Professional cleaning is optional (Shelter) – decide if you want it.

The week before

- [ ] Deep-clean rooms you can live without: spare room, cupboards, oven.
- [ ] Book a bulky-waste collection for rubbish that won't fit in the bins.
- [ ] Ask when the check-out inspection is and whether you can attend.

Kitchen

- [ ] Oven, hob, grill pan and racks.
- [ ] Extractor hood and filter.
- [ ] Fridge and freezer – defrost the day before, wipe inside and seals.
- [ ] Inside and on top of cupboards; tiles and grout behind the hob.
- [ ] Sink, taps and plughole; under and behind appliances you can move.

Bathroom

- [ ] Limescale on taps, shower head, screen and tiles.
- [ ] Toilet, including under the rim and round the base.
- [ ] Extractor fan cover; mirror and cabinet.
- [ ] Mould on sealant – clean small patches; report anything that keeps coming back.

Every room

- [ ] Skirting boards, door frames, handles, switches and sockets.
- [ ] Inside wardrobes and drawers; tops of wardrobes and curtain rails.
- [ ] Window sills, frames and inside glass; radiators.
- [ ] Gently clean wall marks – test first, don't scrub matt paint shiny.
- [ ] Vacuum carpets and mop floors, including under the bed.
- [ ] Remove adhesive hooks slowly, the way the maker says.
- [ ] Furniture back where it was on the inventory.
- [ ] Garden and outside space in a similar state to when you moved in; rubbish cleared.

Moving day

- [ ] Photos and video of every room – wide shots, then close-ups (oven, fridge, bathroom, carpets, any marks). Check the date is saved.
- [ ] Dated photos of meter readings.
- [ ] Return every key and get a receipt.
- [ ] Give your forwarding address in writing.

Getting the deposit back

- [ ] Ask for it back in writing (Shelter: if it's more than a week since you moved out).
- [ ] Your landlord must return it within 10 days of you both agreeing the amount (GOV.UK).
- [ ] No fair-wear-and-tear deductions: small scuffs, faded curtains, worn or frayed carpets (Shelter).
- [ ] Can't agree? Use your scheme's free dispute service – contact it as soon as you can, as there may be a time limit.
- [ ] Keep every photo, email and receipt until the deposit is fully settled.

Rules differ in Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland and can change. This checklist is general information, not legal advice – for your situation, ask Shelter or Citizens Advice.

Sources: Shelter England – Can landlords charge for cleaning and gardening?; What can a landlord keep from your deposit?; How to get your deposit back (england.shelter.org.uk); GOV.UK – Tenancy deposit protection (gov.uk/tenancy-deposit-protection). Checked 29 October 2026. Full guide: therentednest.co.uk/guides/move-out-deposit-checklist-england.html